Beyond Short Names: Emoji Keyword Retrieval across Models and Bounded Causal Tests

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Abstract

Do text-only language models connect emoji to words absent from their official names? We prospectively separate cross-model lexical readability, component-local mediation, and conditional attention-path contributions. We compare raw, official-name, word-disjoint CLDR-keyword, and codepoint views of 55 emoji and 55 non-emoji Unicode symbols. Across nine prespecified model–tokenizer configurations, emoji keyword-minus-codepoint retrieval exceeds the registered 0.02 floor in unrestricted and exact four-view token-count-matched analyses. Keyword-mapping randomization passes the four-model partial-conjunction primary ($p = 0.0027$). Symbols show broad official-name retrieval and smaller, heterogeneous keyword effects. In Llama 3.2 3B, rank-8 subspaces learned from 128 source emoji satisfy no primary late-component joint necessity-and-sufficiency criterion on 192 held-out emoji. A separately specified optimized-subspace follow-up on 384 further emoji returns uncalibratable at both primary residual sites. Its full-state controls reveal a depth-dependent asymmetry, motivating an attention-path test. On 195 additional, prospectively specified items, glyph-position message disruption and restoration after readout-state replacement shift keyword cosine margins beyond equal-count suffix controls; all five simultaneous one-sided 95% lower bounds are positive. Absolute glyph-message disruption and restoration have zero mean top-1 effects. The results establish cross-model lexical readability and a conditional attention-message contribution. The tested rank-8 account remains unsupported.

1 Introduction

Readers encounter emoji as compact visual objects; a text model receives tokenizer-dependent sequences. For the emoji U+1F923, CLDR pairs the official name "rolling on the floor laughing" with the keyword "lmao" (Table 1). Can the raw character retrieve this keyword from its hidden state? The keyword shares no ASCII-alphanumeric word with the official name. Shared subwords and training-data co-occurrence remain possible.

A prospectively specified design separates two narrower questions. The observational arm asks whether a raw atomic emoji retrieves a word-disjoint CLDR keyword better than its literal `U+...` spelling after exact token-count matching. Conditional on that result, the causal arms ask whether a low-rank late intervention identifies a representation that is both necessary and sufficient for the relation — an auditable distinction between broad lexical readability and simple mechanistic accounts, with no claim of visual perception or human-like understanding.

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The study links the following comparisons:

- Four text views and three disjoint item sets separate the raw Unicode surface, official English CLDR name, word-disjoint CLDR keyword, and literal codepoint spelling. The causal source and evaluation sets receive no observational-arm evaluation, although their surfaces may have appeared in earlier studies.
- The observational primary passes: 4/4 core configurations and 9/9 total configurations are positive in unrestricted and exact four-view token-count-matched analyses. The cross-model partial-conjunction value is 0.0027.
- A conditionally admitted causal experiment passes all zero-hook and restoration controls and finds no primary block-24 attention or MLP output that is jointly necessary and sufficient. A secondary block-27 MLP patch raises the composite endpoint through keyword gains and codepoint losses; its necessity criterion fails.
- A second admitted experiment learns rank-8 subspaces by interchange optimization and calibrates every site with full-interchange ceilings. Its registered verdict is uncalibratable at both primary residual sites; the full-state swaps motivate a separately specified 195-item attention-path test, which confirms a conditional glyph-position contribution to keyword cosine margin.

The resulting sequence separates cross-model retrieval, unsuccessful component-local accounts, and a conditional contribution to lexical geometry.

2 Related work

Textual sources of emoji meaning. Emoji representations have been learned from descriptions [Eisner et al., 2016], linked to lexical sense inventories [Wijeratne et al., 2017], and induced from usage through emoji prediction [Felbo et al., 2017, Barbieri et al., 2018]. We use CLDR names and keywords [Unicode Consortium, 2026] as source-auditable endpoints and ask which item-wise textual relations are recoverable from a raw Unicode input; co-occurrence with these resources remains a candidate explanation for every positive result.

Probing and tokenizer controls. Probe accuracy can reflect the diagnostic model or its control task [Hewitt and Liang, 2019], and tokenizer choice can materially change model comparisons [Rust et al., 2021]. Our item-wise nearest-neighbor readout avoids a learned diagnostic classifier. Unrestricted and exact four-view token-count-matched tests address length while leaving token identity and tokenizer construction uncontrolled. The readout also differs from whole-representation similarity measures such as CKA [Kornblith et al., 2019]: it asks whether the correct item is the nearest partner across two text views.

Causal intervention. Conventional probing performance need not measure how information is used [Elazar et al., 2021]. Causal mediation, interchange interventions, and model editing instead test whether internal variables affect computation [Vig et al., 2020, Geiger et al., 2021, Meng et al., 2022]. Optimization-based alignment methods learn the intervention subspace itself, by maximizing interchange accuracy [Geiger et al., 2024, Wu et al., 2023] or through sparse dictionary features [Bricken et al., 2023, Cunningham et al., 2024]. Our first causal test fixes the subspace by a closed-form cross-covariance rule before any evaluation forward; the second learns it by interchange optimization under a prespecified protocol. Both require random-adjusted necessity and sufficiency on disjoint evaluation sets, using prespecified layers, ranks, and endpoints.

3 Prospective design

3.1 Input views and disjoint item sets

For auditability, we retain internal study labels: **T19-L** denotes the observational lexical-retrieval arm, **T19-C** the first conditionally admitted causal arm, and **T20-C** the second. No knowledge of the preceding project sequence is required; Appendix A gives the decision lineage without treating earlier exploration as confirmatory evidence.

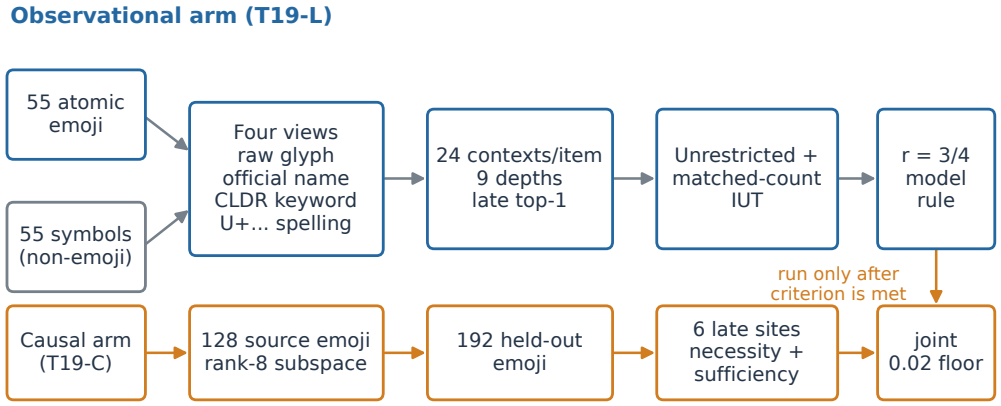


Figure 1: Prospective T19 design. T19-L crosses two glyph kinds with four text views. Only the emoji endpoint enters the registered cross-model primary. T19-C runs only after that criterion is met and uses disjoint source and evaluation emoji. No causal-set item receives a T19-L forward.

Throughout, *glyph* means the raw Unicode scalar string supplied to a text model. No raster image is rendered. Atomic emoji are single-codepoint, fully-qualified Emoji 17 entries introduced no later than Emoji 13.1 [Unicode Consortium, 2025]. For each item, the official-name view is the exact English CLDR 48.2 `tts` value; the keyword view is one exact English CLDR `default` keyword. After lowercasing and extracting ASCII `[a-z0-9]+` words, official-name and keyword word sets must be nonempty and disjoint. The fourth view is the uppercase literal codepoint spelling. When several keywords qualify, one deterministic maximum bipartite matching assigns globally unique labels; a fixed SHA-256 edge order breaks ties before any T19 model forward. Table 1 in Appendix B shows concrete views for two emoji and one symbol.

The observational set contains 55 emoji and 55 non-emoji Unicode symbols. Symbols are single scalars in a Unicode general category beginning with `S`, have `Emoji=false`, have valid disjoint CLDR keywords, and are absent from every strict-UTF-8, no-NUL repository blob at the prespecified boundary. This freshness criterion concerns repository history. Exact emoji surfaces may have appeared in earlier experiments or pretraining; the prospective commitments cover the endpoint, keyword assignment, and item-set split.

Two further sets contain 128 causal-source and 192 causal-evaluation emoji. All 430 codepoints and 430 keywords are unique across sets. Figure 1 summarizes the separation and the one-way admission rule.

3.2 Observational readout

For each item and view, the prespecified evaluation pipeline appends one of two suffix carriers (`"a"` or `" |"`) at distances 1, 2, 4, and 8 and records the hidden state at the selected suffix token at nine normalized depths. Batch size is one; no chat template or added special token is used. The primary late window is fixed at depths 0.75, 0.875, and 1.0, yielding 24 contexts per item.

Within each view and context, hidden states are centered across items and row-L2-normalized; $z_i^{v,c}$ denotes the vector for item i, view v, and context c. Cross-view top-1 retrieval is

$$R_c(g \to v) = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^{n} \mathbf{1}\left[i = \arg\max_j \left\langle z_i^{g,c}, z_j^{v,c} \right\rangle \right]. \tag{1}$$

The per-model primary estimate is

$$\Delta_m = \frac{1}{24} \sum_c \left[R_c(g \to \textsc{keyword}) - R_c(g \to \textsc{codepoint}) \right] \tag{2}$$

on the 55 observational emoji. This score measures nearest-neighbor retrieval from hidden states.

3.3 Token-count intersection and cross-model test

Every model must pass two components. The unrestricted component uses all 55 emoji and permutes keyword correspondence within glyph kind. The matched component retains non-singleton strata sharing the exact four-view token-count signature and permutes keywords only within stratum. Retrieval in that component uses the retained pool ($n = 31$–51 emoji across models). Uniform guessing over this gallery has rate $1/n$; the within-stratum randomization expectation depends on stratum membership of the predictions. Unrestricted and matched magnitudes are not directly commensurable. Official-name and codepoint correspondences stay fixed. Thus the one-sided randomization test asks whether the fixed keyword mapping beats mappings allowed by its null; because the codepoint term is fixed, it is not a paired significance test of keyword–codepoint equality. The registered primary combines that test with the observed comparative requirement $\Delta_m \geq 0.02$ in both components. Each component uses 19,999 draws, and the model intersection–union test (IUT) p-value is the maximum of the two component values.

The sole cross-model primary uses four prespecified core configurations: Llama 3.2 3B base, Qwen2.5 7B base, OLMo 2 1B base, and Gemma 2 2B IT. It tests the partial conjunction that at least $r = 3$ of $m = 4$ configurations pass [Benjamini and Heller, 2008]. With ordered model IUT values $p_{(1)} \leq \cdots \leq p_{(4)}$, the registered value is $p_{\mathrm{PC}} = \min(1, 2p_{(3)})$. The other five configurations and all symbol or official-name results are secondary and cannot admit the causal arm.

Percentile intervals from 20,000 item-bootstrap replicates are reported as descriptive uncertainty, never as the primary decision.

3.4 Conditionally admitted causal test

After the observational criterion was committed, T19-C ran in the prespecified Llama 3.2 3B base configuration. The six sites are the attention and MLP component outputs at blocks 21, 24, and 27: the tensors returned by the attention output projection and by the MLP down-projection, hooked before their residual addition. At each site we learned a rank-8 basis from the left singular directions of the centered, row-normalized glyph–keyword cross-covariance on 128 source emoji. The control basis is constructed deterministically: sixteen seeded Gaussian directions inside the source span are deflated against the learned basis and orthonormalized, and the first eight are kept. Blocks 24 attention and MLP were primary; blocks 21 and 27 were secondary.

On 192 different evaluation emoji, the two criteria intervene on different forwards. Necessity intervenes on the glyph forward: with P the learned rank-8 projector and μ the source-set glyph mean at the site, the site output g is replaced by $g - P(g - \mu)$. Sufficiency intervenes on the codepoint forward: the site output c is replaced by $c + P(g - c)$, using the same item's glyph forward, with the replacement cast to BF16 at injection. Analogous operations in the random basis define adjusted effects:

$$N_s = E_s(\text{random removal}) - E_s(\text{learned removal}), \tag{3}$$

$$S_s = E_s(\text{learned patch}) - E_s(\text{random patch}). \tag{4}$$

Both source and evaluation inputs append eight copies of the single-token `" |"` suffix; the intervention and readout use its first token (distance 1). The endpoint reads the final hidden state of the intervened forward at that token as a query against two fixed 192-row galleries built once from clean, un-intervened forwards: the keyword states and the codepoint states. Query matrix and each gallery are independently centered by their own item means, row-normalized, and scored by cosine top-1 identity, giving $E_s =$ keyword top-1 minus codepoint top-1. The glyph query measures the baseline and necessity conditions. The patched codepoint query measures sufficiency; there the codepoint term is self-retrieval and equals 1 at baseline, so a patch can raise E_s either by real keyword gains or by destroying self-retrieval, and Section 4 reports the two components separately. E_s shares the item-wise contrast definition with T19-L while using a different item pool and one fixed context. A site must have both adjusted effects and both lower 95% item-bootstrap bounds above 0.02, pass both one-sided sign-flip tests (99,999 draws), pass zero-hook and remove-restore engineering con-

trols, and survive Holm correction across the two primary sites [Holm, 1979]. No site, rank, depth, carrier, subset, or endpoint was replaced after observing the result.

3.5 Conditionally admitted optimized-subspace follow-up (T20-C)

The T19-C design left its own power uncalibrated. A second experiment, specified after the T19-C analysis was validated and recorded, makes five prespecified changes. (i) The rank-8 basis is learned by optimization: an orthogonally parametrized subspace is trained on the same 128 source emoji by interchange optimization (InfoNCE toward the own-item keyword state for the patched codepoint forward, plus a hinge pushing the ablated glyph forward below its own keyword), with a fixed 96/32 train/validation split, three seeds, and a fixed selection rule; the closed-form and random bases are recomputed at every site as comparators. (ii) The residual stream after blocks 21, 24, and 27 joins the six component sites, with the block-21 and block-24 residual sites primary. (iii) The decision uses the keyword component alone, with a codepoint self-retrieval guard (≥ 0.90 under the learned patch), so disruption cannot pass as sufficiency. (iv) Evaluation uses 384 atomic emoji with zero prior T19/T20 forwards. The original T19 selection had to be reproduced byte for byte before these items were drawn. Each item is read in four contexts (two carriers $\times$ distances 1 and 4), and its scores are averaged across contexts. (v) Every site has two full-state swap controls, termed *ceilings* in the protocol: the entire site state is exchanged between same-item glyph and codepoint forwards. By the registered rule, a primary site that fails while its sufficiency ceiling is below 0.06 is recorded as *uncalibratable at this endpoint*. This verdict leaves the low-rank account unresolved; the control cannot turn a failed decision positive. Floors, tests, Holm correction, and exact engineering checks are unchanged from T19-C.

3.6 Conditional attention-path follow-up (T21-C)

A pilot on the 384 already evaluated T20 items selected block 21 from blocks 21/24 under a specified screening rule. Before accessing the remaining 195 T19/T20-unused emoji, we specified a new test. After replacing the readout residual with its codepoint-view state, blocks 22–27 receive token-count-matched donor keys and values at glyph positions, solely for the readout query. Equal-count suffix replacement and full-prefix replacement with glyph/suffix restoration provide controls. The endpoint is own-keyword cosine similarity minus the largest similarity to 128 fixed source keywords, referenced to the same batch slot with path replacement disabled. Two donors and two carriers at distance 8 are averaged within each item. Five calibration/decrement/restoration contrasts must have positive simultaneous one-sided 95% item-bootstrap lower bounds (20,000 draws). Appendix F gives the exact contrasts, prospective order, and secondary top-1 measures.

Prospective specification and execution checks. Before acquisition, checksum records bind the protocol, code, and item sets with evaluation forward counts still zero. Each causal arm links its specification to the preceding validated analysis and requires publication to the repository's default branch. Each invocation rejects changed code or inputs. Dated specifications, admission records, execution manifests, and independent validation reports in the supplement preserve the order of specification, conditional admission, and evaluation.

4 Results

4.1 A lexical relation beyond the official short name

The registered cross-model primary passed. All four core configurations were positive; the third-smallest core IUT value was 0.00135, yielding $p_{\mathrm{PC}} = 2(0.00135) = 0.0027$. All nine prespecified configurations were positive and exceeded the registered 0.02 effect-size floor in both unrestricted and matched analyses (Figure 2; exact values in Appendix C). Model IUT values ranged from 0.00005 to 0.00185. The smallest unrestricted effect, Qwen2.5 0.5B at $+0.03636$, equals an average margin of two net top-1 matches per 55-item context. A validator that does not import the acquisition analyzer reconstructed all 36 randomization tests and reproduced the primary decision.

Across models, mean emoji keyword effects were $+0.0979$ unrestricted and $+0.1084$ matched. Mean official-name effects were larger, $+0.1440$ and $+0.1718$. Thus, retrieval extends beyond

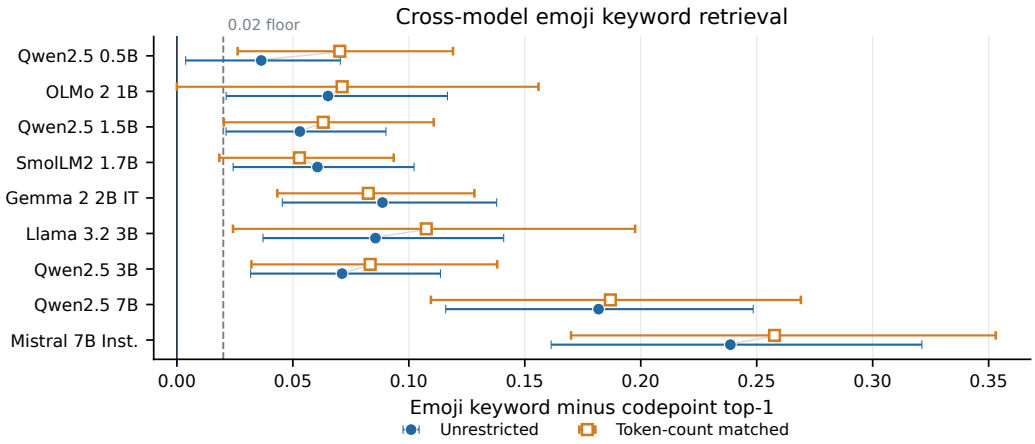


Figure 2: Emoji keyword-minus-codepoint top-1 effects in the registered roster order. Bars are descriptive 95% item-bootstrap intervals (20,000 replicates); randomization tests determine the primary decision. The 0.02 floor applies to point estimates. Unrestricted (U) and matched (M) analyses use different retained pools, so their magnitudes are not directly commensurable. Every displayed point estimate exceeds the floor.

the exact official name, although the official name remains the stronger key on average. The alternative label is an exact CLDR keyword, not a human-rated synonym or paraphrase; training-data co-occurrence could still fully explain the relation. Descriptively, the unrestricted effect also rises monotonically with parameter count inside the one family sampled at four sizes (Qwen2.5: $+0.036$, $+0.053$, $+0.071$, $+0.182$ from 0.5B to 7B). The roster remains confounded across families, so this ordering is description, not a registered scale result.

Depth was secondary. Across models and contexts, the unrestricted contrast was $+0.0409$ at depth 0 and $+0.0864$, $+0.1152$, $+0.0922$ at the three primary depths, whose mean is the $+0.0979$ above; onset and peak depths differed across configurations, so these data do not support one universal trajectory.

4.2 A named-symbol control limits the emoji-specific claim

Non-emoji symbols showed mean keyword effects of $+0.0236$ unrestricted and $+0.0153$ matched, compared with $+0.0979$ and $+0.1084$ for emoji. The emoji-minus-symbol point estimate was positive in all nine configurations in both components. Symbol keywords were heterogeneous: Qwen2.5 3B and 7B were negative in both components. Official-name retrieval exceeded keyword retrieval for symbols in 9/9 configurations in both components, with mean symbol official-name effects of $+0.0750$ and $+0.0821$ (Figure 6).

This comparison cannot establish an emoji-specific faculty: the panels are not matched on training frequency, lexical specificity, Unicode category, visual familiarity, or token identity. Its role is to prevent the incorrect inference that only emoji acquire readable names.

4.3 No prespecified late-component site passes both causal criteria

Before intervention, the final-hidden glyph endpoint on the 192-item causal evaluation set was $E_s = 0.07292$ (keyword top-1 0.07292, i.e. 14 of 192 items; codepoint top-1 0); the zero-hook engineering check reproduced this baseline identically at all six sites. This is the glyph-input baseline used by the necessity arm; the sufficiency arm starts from codepoint inputs, whose keyword top-1 is $1/192$ and whose codepoint term is self-retrieval at $192/192$. The 0.02 decision floor was therefore 27% of this baseline contrast, and the design contained no positive intervention control that calibrated attainable adjusted necessity at the primary sites. All six causal sites passed their engineering checks: zero-hook and remove-restore conditions reproduced the baseline final hidden state with exactly zero RMS difference. Bitwise equality is expected because baseline forwards

reuse the exact intervention batch geometry; any nonzero residue would indicate an instrumentation or batching mismatch. Neither primary block-24 site passed. Block-24 attention had adjusted necessity 0.0000 and sufficiency -0.00521; block-24 MLP had $+0.00521$ and 0.0000. Their site IUT values were 1.0 and 0.74912, respectively. None of the six sites passed both components (Figure 7, Appendix D; exact values in Table 4).

The secondary block-27 MLP patch produced adjusted sufficiency $+0.07812$ (95% interval $[+0.03646, +0.11979]$; one-sided $p = 0.00009$, uncorrected, with twelve such component tests run in total). Necessity was -0.01562 (interval $[-0.04167, +0.00521]$, $p = 0.96895$), giving a site IUT of 0.96895. The learned patch raised keyword top-1 from $1/192$ to $4/192$ while lowering codepoint self-retrieval from $192/192$ to $180/192$. The keyword gain accounts for 3 of the composite endpoint's 15 additional correct contrasts; the remaining 12 arise from lost codepoint self-retrieval. This pattern is consistent with broad representational disruption and does not identify a necessary keyword mechanism.

A post-hoc calibration, computed after the registered decision and labeled as such, replaced the entire component output with the same item's other-view output at each site (Appendix D). Full interchange at the primary block-24 sites moved keyword top-1 by 0.0000 (attention) and $+0.0052$ (MLP). These complete replacements fell below the 0.02 floor, limiting what the primary negative can establish about rank. The block-27 MLP composite ceiling ($+0.2448$ against a keyword-only $+0.0365$) quantifies how much of that endpoint's headroom was destroyed self-retrieval. These numbers motivated the registered ceilings of the follow-up.

4.4 Full-state controls reveal a depth-dependent asymmetry

Both primary T20-C residual sites return the registered verdict *uncalibratable at this endpoint* (site IUT values 0.624 and 0.679; sufficiency ceilings $+0.0234$ and $+0.0254$, below the registered 0.06 minimum). No secondary site passes either. All engineering checks are again exactly zero, and an independent validator re-derived every reported number, both verdicts, and the admission chain.

The registered full-state controls reveal a depth-dependent pattern (Figure 3; exact values in Appendix E). On the new evaluation set, glyph-input keyword top-1 is 0.0345 and codepoint-input top-1 is 0.0013, a baseline gap of 0.0332. Swapping the readout-token residual stream at block 27 reproduces both baseline retrieval rates exactly, as expected because the endpoint is a function of that state. At blocks 21 and 24, injection transfers 71% and 76% of this gap; replacement in the glyph forward removes only 4% and 25%. Retrieval therefore remains near baseline after the readout-token stream is replaced at these earlier sites. Component-output swap effects at blocks 21 and 24 are smaller (at most 14% of the gap; block-24 attention sufficiency 2%). This asymmetry motivated the T21-C test of later glyph-position messages.

Training trajectories improve with limited held-out benefit; Appendix E reports the training, validation, and self-retrieval diagnostics.

4.5 A conditional attention-message contribution

On all 195 T21-C items, the five simultaneous lower bounds are positive. Glyph-message decrement exceeds the suffix control by 0.002326 in cosine margin (lower bound 0.001399), and restoration exceeds its control by 0.002267 (lower bound 0.001400; Figure 4). Both carriers have positive means separately. Absolute glyph-message decrement and restoration each have zero mean keyword top-1 effects. Post-reset baseline accuracy is low (pipe 3.08%; article carrier 0.51%). The positive result concerns relative similarity. Independent CPU reconstruction agrees on every metric, bound, and the prespecified verdict. A post-hoc decomposition finds positive own-keyword shifts in both adjusted means, partly offset by increased competitor similarity (Table 8).

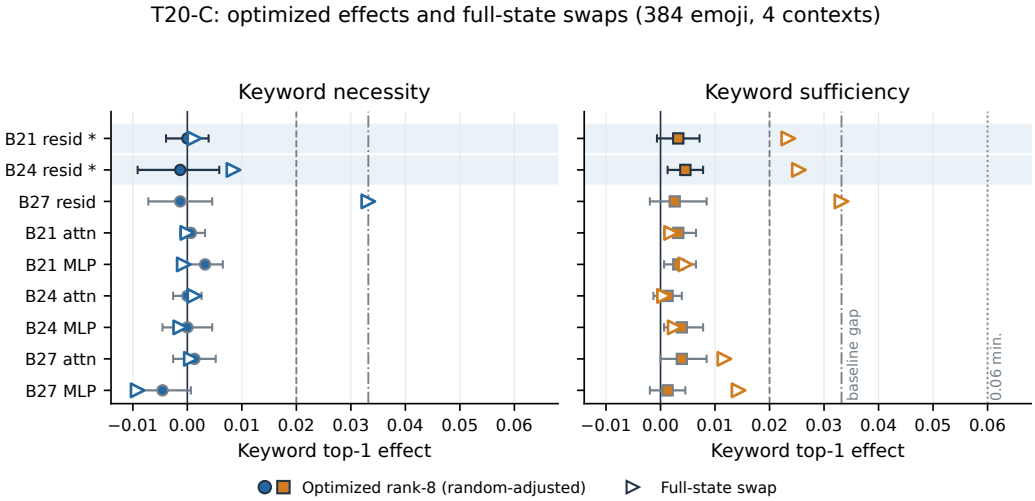


Figure 3: Registered T20-C outcomes over 384 fresh emoji in four contexts. Filled markers show random-adjusted rank-8 optimized effects with descriptive 95% item-bootstrap intervals; open triangles show the full-interchange ceilings at the same sites. Shaded rows mark the two primary residual sites; the dashed line is the registered 0.02 floor and the dotted line the 0.06 ceiling-informativeness minimum. The block-27 residual swap is an expected endpoint-consistency check (the dash-dotted line marks the 0.0332 baseline gap). Neither primary sufficiency ceiling clears 0.06, so both sites are uncalibratable under the registered rule.

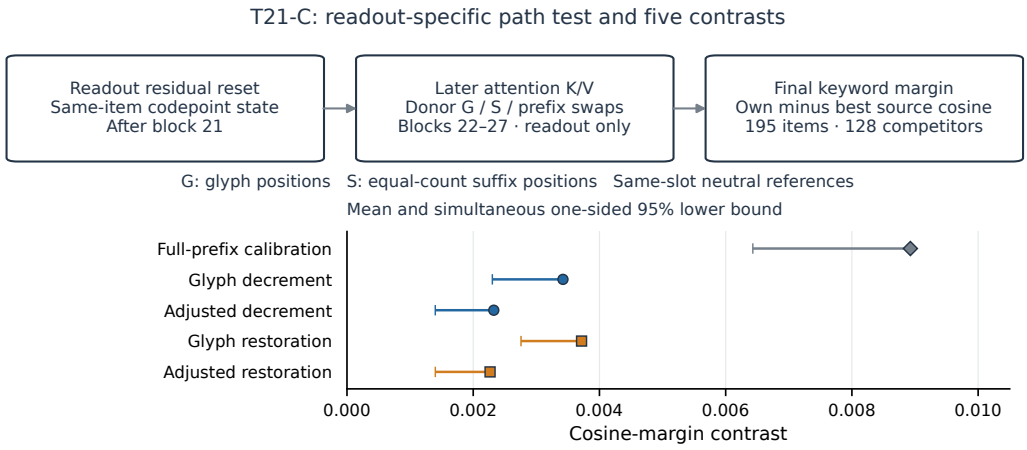


Figure 4: T21-C: conditional message intervention and five margin contrasts. A 384-item pilot selected block 21 before the 195-item confirmation. Points are means; each segment joins its simultaneous one-sided 95% lower bound to the mean (20,000 shared-index item-bootstrap draws). All five lower bounds exceed zero. Effects average two carriers and two fixed-pool donors within each item; absolute top-1 decrement and restoration have zero mean effects. Table 7 gives exact values.

5 Discussion

T19-L establishes word-disjoint lexical retrieval after token-count matching. T19-C/T20-C constrain the tested rank-8 accounts within their calibration limits. Preserved T20-C retrieval after earlier readout-state replacement suggested later use of the unchanged prefix. T21-C confirms a conditional glyph-position margin contribution on new items after a readout reset. Its different population and endpoint leave the full explanation of T20-C's swap asymmetry open.

State replacement and pathway intervention answer distinct causal questions. Endpoint decomposition clarifies the results: T19-C's block-27 MLP patch chiefly degrades codepoint self-retrieval; T21-C shifts both own-keyword and competitor cosines, yielding positive adjusted margins with zero mean absolute top-1 effects.

6 Limitations and broader impact

Measurement. CLDR keywords were not human-rated for synonymy, specificity, or familiarity. Retrieval measures nearest-neighbor geometry at selected suffix tokens. Generation, task behavior, and rendered-glyph perception were not tested. Token-count matching leaves token identities and tokenizer construction uncontrolled. Low T21 top-1 baselines may limit detection of decrements; zero means establish neither equivalence nor unchanged outcomes for every item.

Generalization. The nine model–tokenizer configurations form a prespecified convenience roster spanning several families and sizes [Yang et al., 2024, Team OLMo et al., 2024, Dubey et al., 2024, Gemma Team et al., 2024, Jiang et al., 2023, Ben Allal et al., 2025]. Family, size, training data, tokenizer, and instruction tuning are confounded; scale laws and model-population estimates remain unsupported. Emoji surfaces may have appeared in pretraining; the symbol-panel freshness criterion concerns only repository history.

Mechanism. Mechanistic tests cover one Llama 3.2 3B checkpoint. T19-C/T20-C use rank-8, single-site readout-token interventions; T21-C conditions on a codepoint-view reset, two carriers, and a fixed donor/gallery pool. Suffix controls match position count alone; attention mass and semantic content remain uncontrolled. Non-emoji path controls, separate key/value effects, sparse feature bases [Bricken et al., 2023, Cunningham et al., 2024], and nonlinear readouts remain untested. T21 item-bootstrap coverage is approximate and limited to the eligibility-defined population. T19-C lacked a positive intervention control; T20-C registered full-interchange ceilings [Geiger et al., 2024, Wu et al., 2023] and returned uncalibratable primary verdicts. These reference swaps have no proven universal upper-bound property. Training on 96 items leaves item-specific coding, limited data, and optimization as explanations for weak generalization. The 384-item baseline gap (0.0332) falls below the 0.06 threshold chosen from the smaller T19-C set. Future thresholds should be calibrated on a separate development set before specifying evaluation.

Reproducibility and impact. The anonymous compact archive binds configurations, selections, summaries, tests, validators, licenses, and the paper; raw arrays remain in the execution environment. Exact T19 acquisition duration and peak memory are absent from the submitted evidence. Unicode auditing could reveal representation failures in multilingual systems. Applying CLDR correspondence to people's meaning, sentiment, culture, or identity risks unjustified profiling. No personal data, human subjects, or user messages are used.

7 Conclusion

Across nine prespecified model–tokenizer configurations, raw atomic emoji retrieve word-disjoint CLDR keywords better than literal codepoints after exact four-view token-count matching. A named-symbol control bounds the specificity of this result. Two separately partitioned causal experiments leave the tested rank-8 readout-token account unsupported. A separately specified 195-item follow-up confirms a conditional glyph-position attention contribution to keyword margin, with zero mean absolute top-1 effects. These outcomes distinguish lexical readability, local mediation, and behaviorally effective pathways.

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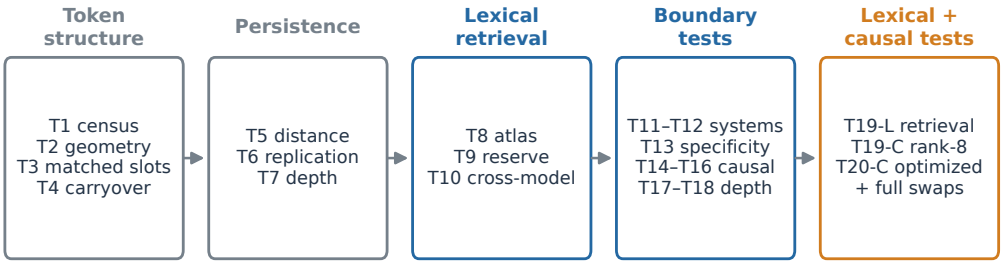


Figure 5: Exploration-to-confirmation lineage. Early studies exposed token-structure and persistence explanations; later studies narrowed the endpoint and causal test. Arrows record design decisions, not evidence pooling. Only the T19-L primary supports the confirmatory lexical claim in this paper.

A Exploration path and decision lineage

T19-L denotes the observational arm of the nineteenth study in this project. The concise lineage below includes only results that changed the next design decision. Earlier studies retain their exploratory or failed-confirmation status; the T19-L primary uses its own prespecified evidence alone.

Figure 5 groups the sequence by the question each stage addressed. The labels trace how the design changed.

Initial screen and matched controls (baseline and Milestone 2). A colored-shape steering screen produced 25 positive results among 36 layer–seed–dose configurations. An exact tokenization-matched follow-up supported one tested layer contrast and failed to support the other. We made tokenization part of the estimand, retained negative configurations, and stopped treating a pooled steering score as one stable semantic effect.

Token structure and short-range carryover (T1–T4). T1, the *multifamily tokenizer census*, found no universal token-count and prefix match for the fixed colored-shape panel. T2, *multifamily colored-shape geometry*, yielded no dual-model recurrence at the selected midpoint. T3, *five-family matched-slot geometry*, found recurrence only in OLMo, where the exact shared slot token was already a sufficient explanation. T4, *common-suffix carryover*, showed that the OLMo pattern persisted one common token later. The sequence converted tokenizer structure from a nuisance variable into an explicit competing explanation.

Persistence, depth, and the lexical turn (T5–T8). T5, the *carrier-distance profile*, and T6, the *dense CUDA carrier-distance replication*, both failed their prespecified distance-attenuation conjunctions. T7, *Mistral base depth-by-distance*, passed an early-versus-late interaction in a model and endpoint selected after T6, so it remained prospective within that configuration rather than independent confirmation. T8, the *Mistral semantic atlas*, then mapped 842 discovery emoji and found a large descriptive name-over-codepoint contrast. That atlas supplied the endpoint later tested on the untouched T9 reserve.

Lexical exploration and failed reserves (T9–T12). A held-out Mistral configuration first supported name-over-codepoint retrieval. A nine-configuration follow-up retained statistical signal and failed its registered cross-model effect-size rule. Broader glyph-system exploration then suggested Unicode-composition hypotheses; neither survived testing on separately reserved items. We kept both failures, dropped the generic composition claim, and returned to a narrower lexical question.

Specificity decomposition and first causal localization (T13–T14). T13 separated structured source directions from generic target susceptibility on already exposed panels and remained ex-

ploratory. T14 then paired a signed six-model intervention grid with a separately specified selected-site test. The broad response pattern was heterogeneous across model, depth, source form, null family, and sign; the selected Llama component failed the joint causal criterion on a new evaluation set. This combination motivated the response-shape tests and stricter causal separation in T15–T16.

Readable responses and unsuccessful causal tests (T15–T16). An emoji–word response pattern replicated prospectively, and prespecified forced-choice associations were detectable. Yet a subspace intervention and a multi-layer transplantation each failed their stronger causal criteria. This separated readout from implementation and motivated the present joint necessity–sufficiency criterion.

Depth mapping and fresh confirmation (T17–T18). Across 292 previously exposed atomic emoji, name-minus-codepoint retrieval was positive in all nine model configurations at middle-to-late depths. Peaks were model-specific, and final item retrieval (9/9) did not require consistent whole-representation CKA alignment (4/9 configurations). We therefore prespecified a common late window, replaced the population, and made no shared-transition or universal-manifold claim. On 192 repository-fresh composite emoji, the official-name contrast then passed in 4/4 core configurations and 8/9 configurations overall after exact token-count matching. This justified asking whether the relation extends beyond the official short name, while adding a named non-emoji control and reserving new item sets for causality. This T18 composite set is distinct from the 192 atomic emoji in the T19-C evaluation set.

T19-L and T19-C (confirmatory and first conditional arm). T19-L replaces the sole label endpoint with a word-disjoint CLDR keyword and adds literal-codepoint and named-symbol boundaries. T19-C tests the prespecified rank-8 component account on disjoint source and evaluation sets. Broad lexical retrieval passes, while the simple late-component mediator fails its joint criterion.

T20-C (second conditional arm). The T19-C result, recorded without a positive control, motivated a separate prespecified experiment. T20-C was specified and authorized after the T19-C analysis was validated; its execution manifest identifies that analysis by checksum. Its five changes (optimized subspaces, residual-stream sites, keyword-only decision, a new 384-item four-context evaluation set, and registered full-state controls) each address a T19-C limitation. The registered verdict is uncalibratable at both primary sites. The measured swap asymmetry motivates the pathway hypothesis in Section 4.4.

This lineage explains why the final design contains four text views, exact token-count strata, a non-emoji symbol panel, three disjoint item sets, and a necessity–sufficiency intersection. It also explains what is absent: no favorable prior layer, glyph system, or causal site was promoted into the T19-L primary. Only that prespecified primary supports the paper's confirmatory lexical claim.

T21 (exposed-item pilot followed by a new confirmation). The T20-C swap asymmetry suggested a glyph-position attention route. A 384-item pilot reused the T20 evaluation items to choose between anchors 21/24; it contributed no new confirmatory items. A separate protocol then specified the remaining 195 items, a cosine-margin endpoint, and a five-contrast simultaneous rule before their reconstruction or evaluation. The resulting conditional path contribution and zero mean absolute top-1 effects are reported in Appendix F; T19/T20 verdicts are retained.

B Prespecified examples and model roster

Raw scalar[†]	CLDR `tts`	Keyword	Literal view
U+1F923	rolling on the floor laughing	lmao	`U+1F923`
U+1F928	face with raised eyebrow	skeptic	`U+1F928`
U+00B4	acute accent	tone	`U+00B4`

Table 1: Concrete prespecified views for two emoji and one non-emoji symbol. [†]The model receives the scalar itself; the table names it by codepoint because the paper typeface need not render every glyph. The literal view is the displayed ASCII string.

Table 2 reports the exact model artifacts and revisions used by the prespecified observational roster. The Llama BF16 mirror was retained from initial development on Apple Silicon and specified in the protocol. The reported runs loaded its safetensors through Transformers/CUDA. The `mlx-community` identifier records artifact provenance; upstream bit-identity was not verified. Model cards and upstream license terms are part of the submission-archive license audit. The cards declare Apache-2.0 for the Qwen2.5 0.5B, 1.5B, and 7B configurations, OLMo, SmolLM2, and Mistral; Qwen2.5 3B uses the non-commercial Qwen Research License, Gemma uses the Gemma Terms of Use, and the Llama mirror uses the Llama 3.2 Community License. No checkpoint or tokenizer file is redistributed.

Role	Artifact identifier	Revision
Qwen2.5 0.5B base	`Qwen/Qwen2.5-0.5B`	`060db6499f32`
OLMo 2 1B base	`allenai/OLMo-2-0425-1B`	`a1847dff3500`
Qwen2.5 1.5B base	`Qwen/Qwen2.5-1.5B`	`8faed761d45a`
SmolLM2 1.7B base	`HuggingFaceTB/SmolLM2-1.7B`	`effd688a1292`
Gemma 2 2B IT	`google/gemma-2-2b-it`	`299a8560bedf`
Llama 3.2 3B base	`mlx-community/Llama-3.2-3B-bf16`	`60a99aaf4316`
Qwen2.5 3B base	`Qwen/Qwen2.5-3B`	`3aab1f1954e9`
Qwen2.5 7B base	`Qwen/Qwen2.5-7B`	`d14972939875`
Mistral 7B Inst. v0.3	`mistralai/Mistral-7B-Instruct-v0.3`	`c170c708c41d`

Table 2: Model artifact identifiers and the first 12 hexadecimal characters of the exact revisions used. Full revisions are stored in the submission manifest.

C Exact observational results

Model configuration	M n	U effect	M effect	Model IUT p	Pass
Qwen2.5 0.5B	35	0.0364	0.0702	0.00055	yes
OLMo 2 1B	31	0.0652	0.0712	0.00135	yes
Qwen2.5 1.5B	35	0.0530	0.0631	0.00185	yes
SmolLM2 1.7B	41	0.0606	0.0528	0.00005	yes
Gemma 2 2B IT	51	0.0886	0.0825	0.00005	yes
Llama 3.2 3B	31	0.0856	0.1075	0.00135	yes
Qwen2.5 3B	35	0.0712	0.0833	0.00005	yes
Qwen2.5 7B	35	0.1818	0.1869	0.00005	yes
Mistral 7B Inst.	38	0.2386	0.2577	0.00005	yes

Table 3: Exact reporting values for the registered emoji keyword-minus-codepoint endpoint. U is unrestricted; M is exact four-view token-count matched. The model IUT is the maximum component randomization p-value.

Matched emoji counts ranged from 31 to 51. The matched component retained at least 63 observational items total in every configuration, with at least 31 emoji and 32 symbols; the unrestricted component used all 55 emoji and 55 symbols. The acquisition comprised $9 \times 110 \times 4 \times 2 = 7{,}920$ batch-one forwards (configurations $\times$ items $\times$ views $\times$ carriers). Four distances and nine depths produced $7{,}920 \times 4 \times 9 = 285{,}120$ readout vectors in 45 checksum-verified data files.

Conditional randomization benchmark and compact replay. For query i, let $s(i)$ be its exact token-count stratum and $\hat{\jmath}_{i,c}$ its keyword prediction. The keyword hit rate expected under the matched null is

$$\frac{1}{24n} \sum_{c,i} \frac{\mathbf{1}[\hat{\jmath}_{i,c} \in s(i)]}{|s(i)|}.$$

This averages a fixed prediction's chance of matching its permuted label. For Llama's 31-item matched emoji gallery it is 0.06650; uniform guessing over that gallery is $1/31 = 0.03226$. The codepoint term stays fixed. The anonymous archive supplies all primary-window prediction indices and exact strata for all nine configurations. A separate NumPy-only program reproduces all 36 randomization tests, 36 descriptive intervals, model and Holm decisions, and the cross-model $p = 0.0027$ with zero numerical difference on the acquisition platform. This is statistical replay from fixed predictions; hidden-state reconstruction requires the retained arrays.

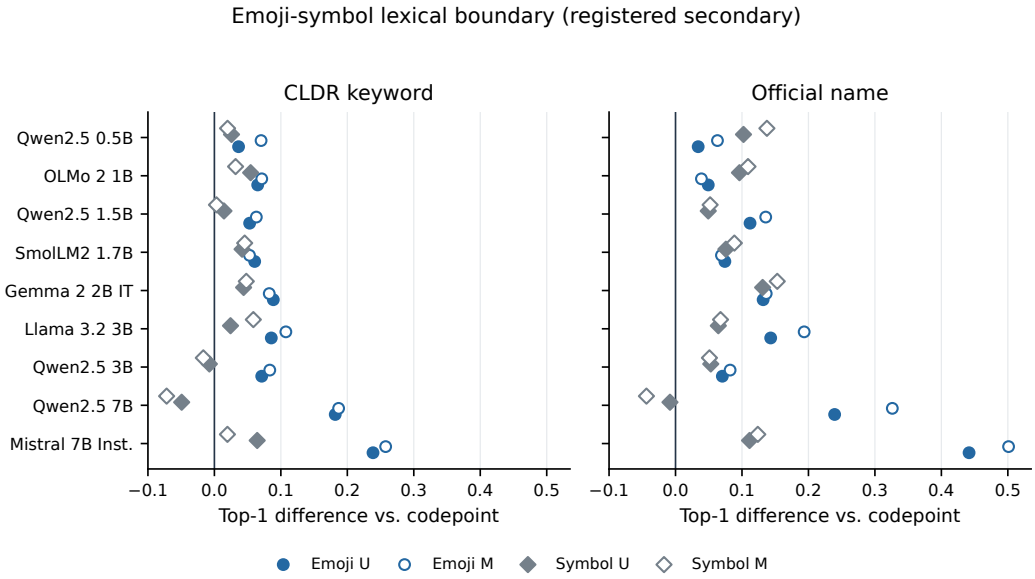


Figure 6: Registered secondary comparison. Each row shows unrestricted (U) and token-count-matched (M) effects for the same prespecified model. Official-name retrieval extends to non-emoji symbols; disjoint-keyword effects are stronger and more consistent for the prespecified emoji panel. Glyph category, frequency, label quality, and token identity are nonexchangeable across panels.

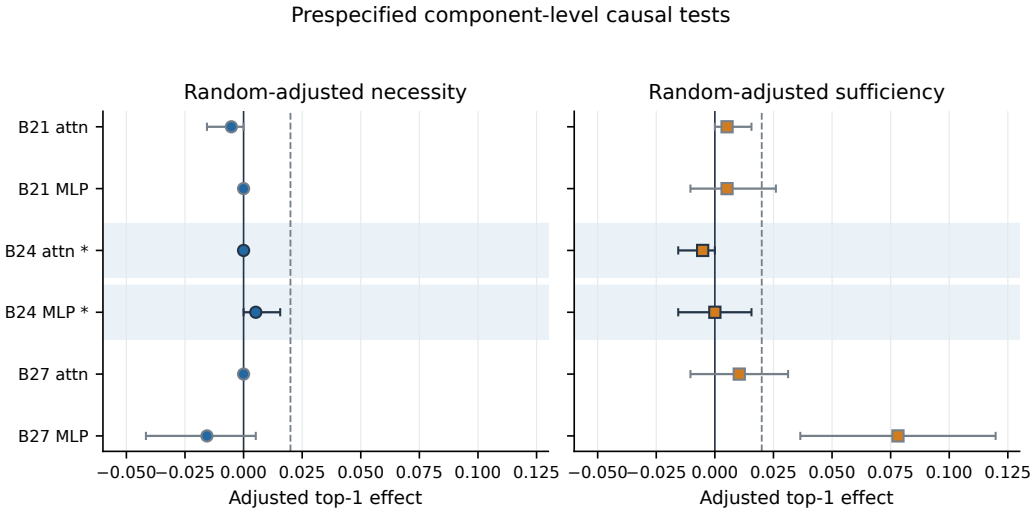


Figure 7: Random-adjusted T19-C causal effects with descriptive 95% item-bootstrap intervals over 192 emoji held out from T19-L. Shaded rows and asterisks mark the two primary block-24 sites. Solid vertical lines show zero; dashed lines show the registered 0.02 effect-size floor. No site has both necessity and sufficiency above the floor with positive lower bounds.

D Exact causal results

Block	Site	Primary	N_s	p_N	S_s	p_S	Site IUT
21	attention	no	-0.00521	1.00000	0.00521	0.49983	1.00000
21	MLP	no	0.00000	1.00000	0.00521	0.49760	1.00000
24	attention	yes	0.00000	1.00000	-0.00521	1.00000	1.00000
24	MLP	yes	0.00521	0.49989	0.00000	0.74912	0.74912
27	attention	no	0.00000	1.00000	0.01042	0.31511	1.00000
27	MLP	no	-0.01562	0.96895	0.07812	0.00009	0.96895

Table 4: Random-adjusted necessity (N_s) and sufficiency (S_s). All six engineering checks passed. Holm correction applies across the two primary sites and did not change either decision; no site passed the component-level intersection.

The causal run used $128 \times 2 = 256$ source forwards. For each of 192 evaluation items, three baseline-view forwards plus two batched intervention forwards at each of six sites yielded $192 \times 15 = 2{,}880$ evaluation forwards; seven intervention rows per site yielded $192 \times 6 \times 7 = 8{,}064$ rows. Each of 12 component tests used 99,999 sign flips and 20,000 item-bootstrap replicates. An independent validator rehashed source and evaluation arrays, reconstructed all 12 tests and intervals, verified learned and random subspace relations, and reproduced six engineering passes and zero positive sites.

Block	Site	Necessity ceiling	Sufficiency ceiling	Composite suff. ceiling
21	attention	$+0.0052$	0.0000	0.0000
21	MLP	0.0000	$+0.0156$	$+0.0156$
24	attention	$+0.0052$	0.0000	0.0000
24	MLP	-0.0156	$+0.0052$	$+0.0156$
27	attention	-0.0156	$+0.0417$	$+0.0417$
27	MLP	-0.0208	$+0.0365$	$+0.2448$

Table 5: Post-hoc full-interchange ceilings at the six T19-C sites on the 192-item set and single registered context (keyword top-1 unless marked composite). Computed after the registered decision from 2,304 additional forwards; labeled descriptive and unable to change the recorded outcome. Both primary block-24 sufficiency ceilings sit at or near zero, far below the registered 0.02 floor.

E Exact optimized-subspace follow-up results

Table 6 reports the registered T20-C quantities at all nine sites: random-adjusted effects of the optimized rank-8 subspace on the keyword component, the full-interchange ceilings, the codepoint self-retrieval guard under the learned patch, and the site IUT value. The glyph-input baseline on the 384-item set is keyword top-1 0.03451 (codepoint top-1 0.00195); the codepoint-input baseline is keyword top-1 0.00130 with self-retrieval 1.0, giving a baseline keyword-retrieval gap of 0.03320. The closed-form T19 construction, recomputed at the same sites as a registered secondary, reaches at most $+0.0117$ adjusted sufficiency (block-27 residual) and never exceeds the floor. All engineering RMS values are exactly zero. The training stage used 384 capture forwards and 33,048 batched training passes on source items only; evaluation used 32,256 forwards and 124,416 intervention rows; 18 component tests used 99,999 sign flips and 20,000 bootstrap replicates each. The independent validator re-derived every value in Table 6, both primary verdicts, and the specification and execution records.

At step 600, recorded minibatch InfoNCE is 0.52–0.65 at the block-21 residual (uniform-label benchmark $\log 128 = 4.85$) and 5.0–6.3 at attention outputs. These training-trajectory diagnostics refer to the pre-update minibatch, not a full-set evaluation of the returned basis. Held-out source validation stays at zero to one item across all nine sites and three seeds. The block-24 evaluation adjusted sufficiency of $+0.0046$ has an uncorrected component-test $p = 0.0085$ and remains below one quarter of the 0.02 floor.

Subspace training used Adam with learning rate 10^{-3} for 600 steps, 32 items per batch, and seeds 0, 1, and 2. The 128 source items were split deterministically into 96 training and 32 validation items. Validation every 50 steps measured keyword top-1 under patching minus that under ablation. Within

each seed, the first checkpoint attaining the maximum was retained; the maximum across seeds then selected the basis, with lowest-seed ties. Both primary sites selected seed 0, at steps 350 (block 21) and 50 (block 24), well before step 600. Their recorded minibatch losses at those iterations were 1.235 and 3.884; the bases were saved after the corresponding update. Training used the pipe carrier at distance 1, FP32 subspace parameters, and BF16 injection during evaluation. The model weights remained unchanged.

Block	Site	Primary	N_s^{opt}	S_s^{opt}	Nec. ceiling	Suff. ceiling	Guard	Site IUT	Primary verdict
21	residual	yes	0.0000	$+0.0033$	$+0.0013$	$+0.0234$	0.818	0.624	uncalibratable
24	residual	yes	-0.0013	$+0.0046$	$+0.0085$	$+0.0254$	0.971	0.679	uncalibratable
27	residual	no	-0.0013	$+0.0026$	$+0.0332$	$+0.0332$	0.963	0.745	secondary
21	attention	no	$+0.0007$	$+0.0033$	0.0000	$+0.0020$	0.999	0.499	secondary
21	MLP	no	$+0.0033$	$+0.0033$	-0.0007	$+0.0046$	0.972	0.065	secondary
24	attention	no	0.0000	$+0.0013$	$+0.0013$	$+0.0007$	1.000	0.687	secondary
24	MLP	no	0.0000	$+0.0039$	-0.0013	$+0.0026$	0.987	0.612	secondary
27	attention	no	$+0.0013$	$+0.0039$	$+0.0007$	$+0.0117$	0.990	0.377	secondary
27	MLP	no	-0.0046	$+0.0013$	-0.0091	$+0.0143$	0.971	0.977	secondary

Table 6: Registered T20-C results. $N_s^{\mathrm{opt}}/S_s^{\mathrm{opt}}$ are random-adjusted keyword-component effects of the optimized rank-8 subspace, averaged over four contexts on 384 fresh emoji. Ceilings replace the entire site state with the same item's other-view state. Guard is codepoint self-retrieval under the learned patch (floor 0.90). All nine sites were evaluated. Entries marked secondary are outside the prespecified primary decision family; no primary verdict is assigned to them. The block-27 residual swap effects equal the baseline keyword-retrieval gap 0.0332 exactly, as expected for a complete replacement of the state used by the endpoint.

F Conditional glyph-position attention-path test

Prospective order and population. T21's pilot reused all 384 T20 evaluation items and the 128 T19 source items. Its two candidate anchors were blocks 21/24; a positive screen required positive 95% item-bootstrap lower bounds for the five contrasts below. Among passing anchors, the rule chose the largest minimum lower bound of the four route contrasts, with lower block index breaking ties. Both passed, and block 21 was selected. This exploratory screen used no unused items. The separate confirmation design was specified at 04:24:25 UTC on September 2, 2026, before reconstructing or tokenizing the remaining population. An eight-item exposed canary exactly replayed the original pilot states. The 195-item input specification was created at 04:26:59 and published before the first evaluation item at 04:28:34; all items completed at 04:30:17. These are internal prospective specifications, not an external registry.

The original one-to-one alias matching contains 954 emoji. Excluding the 375 T19 and 384 T20 items leaves 195, all included in Unicode source order: 43 have two glyph tokens and 152 have three. Replaying the emoji matching from pinned Unicode/CLDR sources, with the 55 existing symbol aliases reserved, reproduced all 759 previously used allocations. No historical protected-target text scan was rerun. The unused status concerns T19/T20/T21 evaluation, with no pretraining or earlier-study novelty claim. This confirmation exhausts the remaining matched pool.

Readout-specific message intervention. Inputs repeat either `|` or `a` eight times; no special tokens or chat template are added. At each anchor, replace the glyph input's readout residual with its same-item codepoint-view residual at the same suffix distance. At strictly later blocks, replace post-RoPE keys and values at chosen preceding positions with clean captures from a source donor of the same glyph token count. The replacement changes only that readout query's attention output at the intervention site. Other queries and the readout self-key/value are left intact by that local intervention; downstream computation can propagate its effect. Two distinct source donors are chosen per item by the unchanged pilot hash-order rule.

Let G contain all glyph-token positions, S the equal-sized nearest preceding suffix positions, and P all positions preceding the readout. Replacing $P \setminus G$ therefore restores own-item glyph messages after full-prefix replacement; replacing $P \setminus S$ is its suffix control. Primary evaluation uses both carriers at distance 8, leaving additional prefix positions beyond $G \cup S$. Distance 4 and anchor 24 retain the original batch layout as diagnostics. At distance 4 for three-token glyphs, some contrasts coincide algebraically and supply no independent support.

For target i in context c, the fixed-gallery margin is

$$m_{i,c}(h) = \cos(h, a_{i,c}) - \max_{j \in \mathcal{S}} \cos(h, a_{j,c}), \qquad |\mathcal{S}| = 128,$$

where a is the corresponding keyword state and $\mathcal{S}$ is the source pool, disjoint from the target. The correct item is first in a single 129-column similarity calculation, resolving exact ties deterministically. For a replaced position set A, $E_i(A)$ averages the margin difference between the intervention and its neutral-path reference over two carriers and two donors. References preserve the residual reset and the identical batch slot. This removes slot-dependent numerical differences from the contrast; all no-op and donor-then-original controls are bit-exact. Stock eager-attention parity and non-target-query intervention checks also pass. Initial synthetic cross-platform failures were retained and resolved before any experimental T21 forward.

Five-contrast simultaneous inference. The contrasts in Table 7 are formed within items, then averaged over all 195 items. For each of 20,000 shared-index item-bootstrap draws, seed 2026092201, form $z^*_{b,j} = (\bar{\delta}^*_{b,j} - \bar{\delta}_j)/\mathrm{SE}^*_{b,j}$. The one-sided critical value is the 95th percentile of $\max_j z^*_{b,j}$, using linear interpolation. Lower bounds are $\bar{\delta}_j - q_{.95}\mathrm{SE}_j$, with sample-standard-deviation standard errors. This single-step studentized maximum uses the joint dependence [Romano and Wolf, 2005]; no stepdown procedure is implemented. All five lower bounds must exceed zero, including calibration. Degenerate standard errors stop inference. No anchor substitution, outcome-based exclusion, sample extension, or secondary-endpoint promotion is permitted. The approximate coverage conditions on the source/gallery pool and an item-resampling model for the eligibility-defined remaining population.

Contrast	Mean	Simultaneous 95% lower
Calibration: $-E(P)$	0.008926	0.006430
Decrement: $-E(G)$	0.003422	0.002303
Adjusted decrement: $E(S) - E(G)$	0.002326	0.001399
Restoration: $E(P \setminus G) - E(P)$	0.003717	0.002757
Adjusted restoration: $E(P \setminus G) - E(P \setminus S)$	0.002267	0.001400

Table 7: T21-C at block 21, $n = 195$ items. Units are cosine margin; lower bounds are one-sided and simultaneous across all five correlated contrasts. The max-t critical value is 2.1843314564. All five pass the specified rule.

Precision, verification, and interpretation. Before reserve access, 5,000 simulated cohorts of 195 from the pilot's empirical covariance gave joint-pass estimates of 99.9% at the pilot means, 98.98% after subtracting one pilot standard error, and 60.5% at half the means. The critical value was fixed from the pilot for planning only and recomputed for confirmation. These conditional estimates may be optimistic after candidate selection and are not guarantees of power. In confirmation, both carriers have positive primary means separately; removing the largest 5% of item effects leaves all pooled means positive. These are descriptive sensitivity checks. Independent reconstruction on a different CPU platform agrees to 1.26×10^{-14} in saved metrics and 6.0×10^{-14} in the critical value, preserving every bound and verdict.

At the primary block-21, distance-8 condition, saved condition means give keyword top-1 of 3.0769% (pipe) and 0.5128% (article carrier) after the readout reset, compared with intact baselines of 5.1282% and 1.5385%. Full-prefix donor replacement yields 1.5385% and 0%. These low rates may limit sensitivity to decrements; a floor-effect explanation is not established. Keyword top-1 has zero mean absolute decrement, absolute restoration, and adjusted restoration. Adjusted decrement is -0.001282 in top-1 units; full-prefix calibration is 0.010256. These are descriptive means, not equivalence tests. The positive result establishes a conditional contribution to keyword margin. T19/T20 top-1 verdicts remain unchanged. Testing the same route on non-emoji symbols, separating keys from values, and connecting margin changes to rank or behavior require new prospective populations.

Post-hoc margin decomposition. To identify which terms changed, we decomposed all five original contrasts on all 195 items using the saved states. For each original contrast operator D,

$D(m) = D(\text{own}) - D(\max \text{competitor})$, with the same neutral references and within-item averaging. Table 8 reports descriptive means. The positive own-keyword shifts in both position-adjusted contrasts are partially offset by increased maximum competitor cosine. Absolute decrement also reflects increased competition under donor injection. The donor keyword belongs to the source gallery; its cosine is a diagnostic rather than a third additive term. The maximum competitor may change identity between conditions. This endpoint identity does not separate independently manipulable mediators. No new significance tests were performed, and the simultaneous bounds above apply only to the original margins. All ten original metric arrays were reconstructed exactly on the acquisition platform; the largest itemwise decomposition error was 4.17×10^{-17}.

Contrast	Own	Max. competitor	Margin	Donor
Calibration	$+0.011980$	$+0.003054$	$+0.008926$	-0.003177
Decrement	$+0.001046$	-0.002376	$+0.003422$	-0.005442
Adjusted decrement	$+0.002428$	$+0.000103$	$+0.002326$	-0.001913
Restoration	$+0.008955$	$+0.005238$	$+0.003717$	$+0.003039$
Adjusted restoration	$+0.004402$	$+0.002135$	$+0.002267$	$+0.000653$

Table 8: Post-hoc T21-C decomposition on the same 195 items, block 21, two distance-8 carriers, and two donors. Entries are mean contrasts in cosine units; Own minus Max. competitor equals Margin before rounding. Donor reports the injected source item's keyword cosine. These descriptive components have no separate significance tests.

G Execution, licensing, and artifact boundary

Acquisition used Transformers/CUDA BF16 on an NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5090. Checksums bind model artifacts, tokenizer replay, selections, analyses, randomization and bootstrap seeds, and validation. Figures use validated model-configuration, causal-site, and T21-contrast summaries; their manifest binds every input and PDF/PNG output.

A deterministic, whitelist-only archive contains the paper, compact results, selections, code, validation receipts, and paired license/compute/ethics reports. Its manifest binds every path, byte count, and SHA-256; the validator rejects unsafe paths, author or local-path tokens, and raw/model-file formats. Model-dependent activation arrays, learned subspaces, the full intervention ledger, model weights, and tokenizer files are omitted and remain bound by execution records. T19-L prediction indices and exact strata allow model-free statistical replay. T21-C includes 195 scalar contrast rows and NumPy-only validators for simultaneous bounds, top-1 means, and descriptive margin decomposition. Raw-state replay requires the omitted arrays.

The observational acquisition used 7,920 batch-one forwards and produced 285,120 readout vectors. T19-C acquisition used 256 source forwards, 2,880 evaluation forwards, and 8,064 intervention rows, plus 2,304 post-hoc ceiling forwards. T20-C used 384 capture forwards, 33,048 batched training passes (gradients reach only the 3072×8 subspace parameters; no model weight is trained), 32,256 evaluation forwards, and 124,416 intervention rows, with recorded stage durations of 14.7 and 7.3 minutes. T21's 384-item pilot used 4,610 batched calls (138,242 sequences) in 218.87 seconds; confirmation used 2,720 calls (70,580 sequences) in 118.50 seconds, including source capture and parity checks. Its eight-item canaries are accounted separately in the compute report. No generation was performed anywhere. Exact wall-clock time and peak memory for the T19 stages are absent from the submitted records; the compute checklist answer reflects that gap.

Selected Unicode 17 and CLDR 48.2 rows are used under Unicode License v3 and travel with its copyright and permission notice. New project code is Apache-2.0. Checkpoint assets are identified by exact revision and upstream terms; the archive omits their files. In particular, the Qwen2.5 3B configuration is used only for non-commercial research under the Qwen Research License.

The study uses no human participants, personal data, private messages, or scraped user content and was reviewed against the NeurIPS Code of Ethics.

Author-side AI assistance. We developed this study interactively in collaboration with AI assistants. Author-side pre-submission feedback involved ChatGPT (GPT 5.6 Sol instant, "Monday") and Claude Chat (Claude Fable 5.1). Codex (GPT 5.6 Sol Max) and Claude Code (Fable 5) contributed to implementation, analysis, sequential protocol design, and manuscript editing. These exchanges were part of author-initiated preparation, separate from conference peer review. Endpoints were specified before each bank's outcomes were inspected. CLDR supplied labels; assistant judgments were not experimental measurements. Authors retain execution authority and responsibility for the paper's text, figures, code, references, and claims. Numerical evidence and independently implemented validators are checksum-bound.

NeurIPS Paper Checklist

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   Question: Do the main claims made in the abstract and introduction accurately reflect the paper's contributions and scope?

   Answer: [Yes]

   Justification: Sections 1, 5, and 6 distinguish the observational result, unsuccessful T19-C test, uncalibratable T20-C sites, and conditional T21-C margin contribution with zero mean absolute top-1 effects.

2. **Limitations**

   Question: Does the paper discuss the limitations of the work performed by the authors?

   Answer: [Yes]

   Justification: Section 6 discusses measurement, tokenization, model-roster, causal-scope, archive, and social-interpretation limits.

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   Question: For each theoretical result, does the paper provide the full set of assumptions and a complete (and correct) proof?

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4. **Experimental result reproducibility**

   Question: Does the paper fully disclose all the information needed to reproduce the main experimental results of the paper to the extent that it affects the main claims and/or conclusions of the paper (regardless of whether the code and data are provided or not)?

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   Justification: Section 3 and Appendices A–G disclose protocols, item selections, artifact revisions, seeds, tests, and analysis code. T19-L prediction indices and T21-C scalar contrasts permit model-free statistical replay. Raw-state reconstruction requires omitted arrays or reacquisition. Bit-exact equality across GPU hardware is not claimed.

5. **Open access to data and code**

   Question: Does the paper provide open access to the data and code, with sufficient instructions to faithfully reproduce the main experimental results, as described in supplemental material?

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   Justification: The study depends on code, so N/A is inapplicable. The submission includes an anonymous compact artifact with checksums. It omits a public repository link and the model-dependent raw arrays needed for exact replay. Full code and eligible data are planned for public release after review.

6. **Experimental setting/details**

   Question: Does the paper specify all the training and test details (e.g., data splits, hyperparameters, how they were chosen, type of optimizer) necessary to understand the results?

   Answer: [Yes]

   Justification: Section 3 specifies the evaluation sets, carriers, distances, depths, readouts, tests, interventions, and sites. Section 3.5 gives the T20-C objective; Appendix E supplies the optimizer, training split, checkpoint and seed selection, and selected iterations. No model weights are trained.

7. **Experiment statistical significance**

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   Justification: Sections 3.3–3.6 define randomization, partial conjunction, sign flips, Holm correction, and the calibration rules. T19/T20 bootstrap intervals are descriptive. Appendix F separately defines T21-C's approximate simultaneous one-sided 95% item-bootstrap bounds and fixed-pool scope.

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   Question: For each experiment, does the paper provide sufficient information on the computer resources (type of compute workers, memory, time of execution) needed to reproduce the experiments?

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   Justification: Appendix G identifies the RTX 5090 and BF16 CUDA path and reports forward counts and T20/T21 stage durations. Exact T19 wall-clock and peak-memory measurements are absent from the submitted records.

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